

CANDID Camera

Moments make memories. And it is precisely in these memories that a nation traces its social and political roots. INDIA TODAY captures the mood of the country over the last 33 years through a rare collection of 33 snapshots. From Indira Gandhi saluting the nation to Morarji Desai's plunge into the deep end, from L.K. Advani's tryst with make-up to Field Marshal Sam Manekshaw's Barbie fixation. This is power and fame at its most human and real. To take photographs is to hold one's breath when all faculties converge in the face of fleeting reality, said Henri Cartier-Bresson. These portraits, some taken on the run, others at great leisure, embody just that. History, in a flash.

THE LAST GOODBYE

Indira Gandhi

1982

She was the maximum leader, adored as Durga, feared as Kali. In November 1984, just a day before she was assassinated, INDIA TODAY quoted her as saying, "If I die today, every drop of my blood will invigorate the country." Here the former prime minister is seen addressing a Congress Seva Dal meet in Delhi.

PHOTOGRAPH BY: BHAWAN SINGH

